

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience implementing, managing, and continuously improving enterprise-grade security programmes across complex, regulated, and high-availability environments. I have extensive hands-on expertise across the full security technology stack: Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel; Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender; email security using Mimecast; Identity and Access Management (IAM) using Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AD); Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust; endpoint management using Microsoft Intune; and vulnerability management using Tenable.io and AppCheck. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have a strong background in incident response leadership, threat hunting, detection engineering, and penetration test remediation. I am experienced working within small, focused security teams where breadth of ownership across the full technology stack and strong stakeholder communication are essential. I am comfortable operating in regulated financial services environments where security excellence directly supports business continuity and client trust.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, Logic App playbooks, workbooks, data connectors); detection engineering, alert triage, automated response orchestration
- **EDR / XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, RTR); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; integrated XDR across endpoint, identity, and cloud
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email gateway; WAF administration; web/email security gateway management; IDS/IPS; DDoS mitigation
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD; Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Group Policy
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; just-in-time access, standing privilege elimination, privileged session recording
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM; device compliance; application management; endpoint hardening
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); full lifecycle: scan, triage, remediate, report
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring and maintenance
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall; Tanium; security certificate lifecycle; penetration test remediation

- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; SOAR automation
- **Governance and Compliance:** NIST CSF; CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials+; MITRE ATT&CK; JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Senior security engineering lead with full ownership of the university's security technology stack spanning EDR, SIEM, SOAR, IAM, PAM, endpoint management, email security, vulnerability management, and incident response across an 8,000-user environment.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon platform (NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) across 8,000 endpoints; develop detection rules, conduct threat hunting, and execute endpoint containment via Falcon Real Time Response (RTR).
- Design and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace: configure data connectors, author KQL analytics rules, automate response via Logic App playbooks, and deliver workbook dashboards for security leadership visibility.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to deliver integrated XDR capability covering endpoint, identity, email, and cloud vectors.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway: configure policies, integrate threat intelligence, manage incident escalation, and report on gateway performance to the Information Security team.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory: Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and identity lifecycle governance.
- Lead BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) programme: eliminate standing admin rights, enforce just-in-time privilege elevation, and manage privileged session oversight.
- Administer Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for 8,000+ users: device compliance policy management, application lifecycle, and endpoint security hardening aligned to CIS Controls.
- Oversee WAF/DDoS mitigation, IDS/IPS configuration, firewall management, and security certificate lifecycle across the network perimeter.
- Lead the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS: coordinate full lifecycle from scan through remediation to board-level reporting.
- Serve as senior incident response escalation lead: investigate, contain, and recover from security incidents including ransomware, business email compromise (BEC), credential compromise, and data exfiltration attempts, in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Author, maintain, and test incident response playbooks; coordinate cross-functional response teams during major incidents; deliver post-incident lessons learned to senior stakeholders.
- Remediate penetration testing findings, manage security certificate lifecycle, and deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations to build a security-first culture.

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across the full university estate and designed the hybrid SOC architecture integrating CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Designed and built Microsoft Sentinel workspace from the ground up, including data connector configuration, KQL analytics rule authoring, Logic App playbook automation, and executive workbook dashboards.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) for 8,000 users, delivering an integrated XDR capability.
- Managed daily SIEM alert triage, SOAR automation, and threat hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry; coordinated incident response in line with NIST 800-61.
- Administered Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, and Tanium for email security, firewall management, and endpoint visibility across a complex, multi-site environment.
- Supported vulnerability assessments (Nessus, AppCheck), triaged findings, coordinated remediation, and contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 alignment.

**IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/
FinTech)**

*February 2021 – March
2022*

- Managed IT security controls, endpoint management (Intune/MDM), and identity services (Azure AD, MFA, SSO) for a cloud-first SaaS/FinTech organisation.
- Implemented security hardening across Microsoft 365 and Azure environments, reducing attack surface and improving compliance posture against ISO 27001 and CIS Controls.
- Administered network security including firewall rules, VPN access controls, and endpoint protection configuration; conducted security risk assessments and supported internal audits.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user estate and built a hybrid SOC integrating NG-SIEM, EDR, and Microsoft Sentinel, significantly reducing mean time to detect and respond.
- Designed Microsoft Sentinel workspace from scratch with 50+ analytics rules, automated Logic App playbooks, and leadership-facing workbook dashboards.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) for 8,000 users, establishing integrated XDR across endpoint, identity, and cloud surfaces.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM programme, achieving zero-standing-privilege posture for all privileged accounts across the organisation.
- Led Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises, identifying and closing critical detection and prevention control gaps mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 alignment programme across the full organisation.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**

- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 85,000 – 100,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)